

Free Tax Filing

You should never have to pay to file your taxes. Millions qualify to file free — online or with free in-person help — and keep their whole refund. Below are the official free options. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

About 100 million people can file free but most don't know it. Note: the IRS "Direct File" pilot was canceled for 2026 — use the options below instead. Never pay a preparer who takes a cut of your refund.

1 File Free Online

Free guided software if your income is under the limit.

☐ IRS Free File

Free guided tax software if your income is \$89,000 or less. Available only through IRS.gov.

→ www.irs.gov/file-your-taxes-for-free

☐ Free File Fillable Forms

Free electronic forms for any income level if you're comfortable doing your own return.

→ www.irs.gov/e-file-providers/free-file-fillable-forms

2 Free In-Person Help

IRS-certified volunteers prepare your return for free.

☐ VITA — Volunteer Income Tax Assistance

Free tax prep for people generally earning under ~\$67,000, people with disabilities, and limited-English speakers.

→ www.irs.gov/individuals/free-tax-return-preparation-for-qualifying-taxpayers 1-800-906-9887

☐ AARP Foundation Tax-Aide

Free tax help, with a focus on people 50+ and lower incomes. No AARP membership needed.

→ www.aarp.org/money/taxes/aarp_taxaide

☐ TCE — Tax Counseling for the Elderly

Free help for those 60+, specializing in pension and retirement questions.

→ www.irs.gov/individuals/free-tax-return-preparation-for-qualifying-taxpayers

3 Free Help Online & for Military

Virtual prep and a no-income-limit option for military.

☐ GetYourRefund

Free virtual tax prep connecting you with VITA volunteers online.

→ www.getyourrefund.org

☐ MilTax — Military

Free filing for service members and many veterans, with no income limit.

→ www.militaryonesource.mil/financial-legal/taxes/miltax-military-tax-services

4 Don't Miss Your Refund

Filing free also unlocks valuable refundable credits.

☐ Claim the EITC & Child Tax Credit

Even if you owe no tax, filing can get you thousands back. See the Tax Credits guide.

→ See: [Tax Credits You May Be Missing guide](#)

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Avoid “refund anticipation” loans and preparers who take a percentage of your refund — they eat into money that’s yours. The free options above are safe and keep 100% of your refund.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Use a VITA or AARP Tax-Aide site if your return involves the EITC — certified volunteers catch mistakes and make sure you get every dollar you’re owed.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national free options. For a VITA or Tax-Aide site near you and your state’s free filing, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find the closest one.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
